

DOCUMENT APPROVAL SYSTEM

Why Is Meta Interested in Adopting AV1 for RTC?

The motivation for switching to a more advanced video codec is straightforward — it delivers the same visual quality while using much less bandwidth. In offline tests, we observed at least a 20% bitrate reduction with AV1 compared with H.264/AVC under our product settings on low-end and mid-range devices. If devices can accommodate higher encoding complexity, the bitrate reductions are even greater. For real-time video calls, this means people on slower or limited networks can enjoy significantly better video quality. This is important to our users because, to meet low-latency requirements, the RTC product must handle bitrate fluctuations. In real-world networks — especially in emerging markets — video bitrates for RTC products typically range from 10 kbps to 400 kbps. Maintaining good video quality below 100 kbps remains challenging.

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